1874

Peking. 9.

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No. 136

Peking
10 July 1874

My Lord

From private information on which I can rely, it would appear that the Japanese are preparing to establish themselves also on the north-east coast of Formosa.

Rather more than a month ago, four Japanese left Kelung, ostensibly on a pleasure trip, in

The Right Honorable
The Earl of Derby
&c &c &c

in a boat belonging, I think, to a Portuguese who accompanied them. About fifty miles down the East coast they entered a stream which they were unable to stem. The natives consequently dragged the boat in for them; but over the rocks; which nearly stove her in. The Japanese distributed trinkets and money and began to bargain for the erection of several large grass houses. This was agreed to; but when their effects were landed, an angry

discussion

discussion commenced among the Chinese themselves as to the terms for storage. The Portuguese boat owner was for retreating, but the Japanese said that they had come to arrange for the landing of a force, and that gunboats would soon follow. The Portuguese thereon made terms with a native boatman for his conveyance to a known point on the coast, and left; one of the Japanese coming back with him to Tamsui.

The population about the

river

river abovementioned are a mixed lot of Chinese, Pepohwans (see Mr. Bullock's Report) and Savages, and bear a bad repute.

There is at this time a Japanese Consul at the port of Taiwan who assures the Taotai that the Japanese contemplate action only in the South of the Island. The Customs Inspectorate, I understand, have orders to allow the Japanese to coal at Kelung.

I have the honor to be,

My Lord,

With

With the highest respect,

Your Lordship's most obedient

humble Servant

Thomas Francis Wade.

1874

Peking 10th July

Mr Wade's

No. 186

Recd Sept 21

Formosa. Japanese also in North of F.

To The Queen

Mr Disraeli

Circulate

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Peking

10 July 1874

No. 187

My Lord

On the 17th June the position of the Japanese, in the South of Formosa, appeared to be this. They had suspended operations against the Mou-tan or Bow-tan Savages and the Koaluts, and were in possession of that part of the Island lying South of Hongkong (a village some ten miles North of Langkiao

The Right Honorable

The Earl of Derby

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